

The Brave Little First Day

Written by Wilson Yeu

Illustrated by AI



For every child who's ever felt nervous
about something new.

You are braver than you know.



Maya woke up early, before the sun.
Her tummy felt like butterflies were dancing inside.

"Today is the day," Mama said, smoothing Maya's hair.
"The day you start your new school."

Maya nodded, but the butterflies wouldn't stop.



Maya put on her favorite yellow dress — the one with the tiny stars.
She packed her backpack: a pencil, an eraser, and one small seashell from
the beach.

"The seashell is for courage,"
Maya whispered.



The walk to school felt very long.

Maya saw other children laughing and running ahead.

Their backpacks bounced like they were full of happy secrets.

Maya's butterflies fluttered faster.



The school was big. BIGGER than Maya remembered.

The door was red. The walls were tall.

The hallway stretched forever.

"Everybody already knows each other,"

Maya thought.

"They probably have best friends already."



Maya found her classroom. Room 4.
A colorful rug sat in the corner.
Drawings hung on every wall.

The teacher smiled.
"Welcome! You must be Maya."

But all the seats were taken — except one, right in the middle.
Maya sat down. Her seashell was quiet in her pocket.



At lunch, Maya sat alone.
She ate her sandwich slowly.
She watched the other kids play tag.

"Maybe I don't belong here,"

Maya thought.

The butterflies turned into a big, heavy rock.



Then — a voice.
"Is that a seashell?"

A boy with glasses and a gap-tooth smile was pointing at Maya's pocket.

"I have one too!" he said, pulling out a tiny green stone.

"Mine's from my grandma's garden. Where's yours from?"



"The beach," Maya said. "My dad and I found it."

"That's cool," the boy said. "I'm Sam.
Want to play? We're building a castle."

Maya looked at the playground.
The castle was half-built, waiting for more hands.



Maya held her seashell tight. Then she let go.

"One castle, coming up!"

She ran to the playground. Sam ran beside her.

The other kids moved over to make room.

"Need a drawbridge?" asked a girl with braids.

"I can make a flag!" said a boy with paint on his shirt.



The castle grew. It had towers and walls and a moat made of leaves.

Maya didn't feel the butterflies anymore.

Or maybe they were still there —
just flying in the same direction now.



Walking home, Maya held Mama's hand.

"How was school?" Mama asked.

Maya smiled.

"The butterflies are my friends now."

"They just needed somewhere to land,"

Mama said.



The next morning, Maya woke up before the sun again.

But this time, the butterflies felt different.

Not scary. Exciting.

She put on her yellow dress.

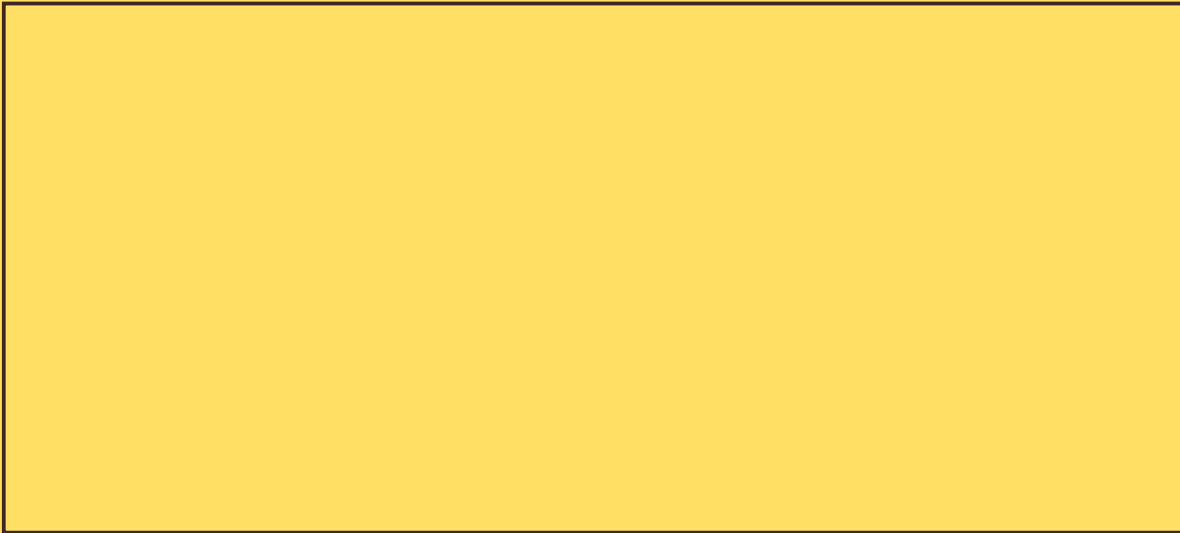
She packed her seashell.

**And she walked to school —
a little faster than yesterday.**

Your Brave Little Moment!

Sometimes we feel nervous, and that's okay.

Draw or write about a time you did something brave:

A large, empty rectangular box with a black border, intended for a child to draw or write about a brave moment.

(Draw your brave moment in the box above)

I felt nervous when:

I felt brave when:

Now I know:

A Note for Grown-Ups

Starting something new — a school, a class, a friendship — is one of the hardest things a child can do. This book helps children:

- Name their feelings (butterflies = anxiety)
- Find courage in small things (a seashell, a stone)
- Discover that belonging starts with one connection
- Understand that nervousness and excitement feel similar

Discussion Questions

1. What did Maya feel in her tummy?

Have you ever felt that way?

2. What's something small that makes you feel brave?

3. How did Maya's day change after she met Sam?

4. What can you say to someone who looks nervous on their first day?

About the Author

Wilson Yeu is a real estate advisor by day and a storyteller by night. He writes stories that help children navigate big feelings with courage and kindness.

The Brave Little Series

Book 1: The Brave Little First Day

Book 2: The Brave Little Mistake (coming soon)

Book 3: The Brave Little Storm (coming soon)

Thank you for reading!

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